Metals Market Index MMI

MMi Dashboard

Iron Ore Price Indices

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI61 61% Fe Fines RMB/t

796
2 0.19%
Mar 16th, 2026

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI65 65% Fe Fines RMB/t

904
13.77 1.55%
Mar 16th, 2026

Iron Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI58 58% Fe Fines RMB/t

723
-1 -0.07%
Mar 16th, 2026

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI61 61% Fe Fines USD/dmt

105.35
-0.15 -0.14%
Mar 16th, 2026

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI65 65% Fe Fines USD/dmt

122.70
-1.25 -1.01%
Mar 16th, 2026

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPLI 62.5% Fe Lump RMB/t

910
37 4.24%
Week Ending Mar 13th, 2026

Exchange Traded Contracts

DCE Iron Ore 62% Fines
I2605 (May) RMB/t (3pm close)

809.00
-2.50 -0.31%
Mar 16th, 2026 (3pm close)

SGX Iron Ore (CFR Qingdao) 62% Fe Fines
March 26 USD/dmt

107.50
-0.15 -0.14%
Mar 16th, 2026 (5.30 pm Print)

SHFE Rebar
RB2605 (Jan) RMB/t

3140
-2 -0.06%
Mar 16th, 2026 (3pm close)

Freight Rates

C3, Tubarao - Qingdao USD/t

29.66
1.26 4.4%
Mar 13th, 2026

C5, W. Australia - Qingdao USD/t

12.96
0.98 8.2%
Mar 13th, 2026

Steel Price

Steel Rebar (China Domestic) RMB/t

3164
31 0.99%
Week Ending Mar 13th, 2026

Inventory Levels

Iron Ore Inventory at Chinese Ports (35)
million tonnes

155.41
0.61 0.39%
Week Ending Mar 13th, 2026

Steel Inventory in China
million tonnes

15.16
0.40 2.68%
Week Ending Mar 13th, 2026

Steel Price

Steel HRC (China Domestic) RMB/t

3282
57 1.76%
Week Ending Mar 13th, 2026

IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX (IOPI)

Mar 16th, 2026		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	796	2	0.2%	787	828	683	1063	106.91	0.13	0.1%	102.55	108.09	89.33	140.24
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	723	-1	-0.1%	694	727	610	963	97.94	-0.14	-0.1%	90.90	95.56	80.25	128.13
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	904	14	1.5%	896	938	794	1175	121.99	1.83	1.5%	117.28	122.96	104.47	155.37

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX (IOSI)

Mar 16th, 2026		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	105.35	-0.15	-0.14%	103.47	109.07	89.79	142.65
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	122.70	-1.25	-1.01%	115.59	123.67	98.23	171.65

MARKET COMMENTARY

Today , DCE iron ore futures first fell and then rebounded today. The most-traded contract I2605 eventually closed at 809 yuan/mt, down 0.74% from the previous trading session. Traders were only moderately active in offering prices, while steel mills made fewer inquiries, with purchases mainly driven by rigid demand. Overall, transactions in the spot market were relatively subdued.

Last week, SMM's total global iron ore shipments rose 4.13 million WoW to 31.97 million mt, up 14.85%. Meanwhile, total port arrivals in China reached 28.13 million mt, up 5.06 million WoW, an increase of 21.93%. The surge in port arrivals further highlighted resistance on the fundamentals side. At the same time, the release of certain iron ore products from ports also weighed on today's spot procurement demand. Together, these factors curbed bullish sentiment toward iron ore to some extent. Looking ahead, although the supply side was relatively loose this week, blast furnaces that had undergone maintenance earlier are expected to resume production in a concentrated manner this week. The market is expected to shift into a structure of both strong supply and demand this week. Meanwhile, the iron ore market has once again entered a phase of structural shortage, while continuously rising freight rates also provided cost support for iron ore. Therefore, ore prices are expected to hover at highs or hold up well in the short term.

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX (IOPLI)

Week Ending Mar 13th, 2026		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [3]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	W-oW	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	910	37	4.2%	895	953	820	1210	117.83	5.16	4.58%	112.19	119.69	102.77	153.57

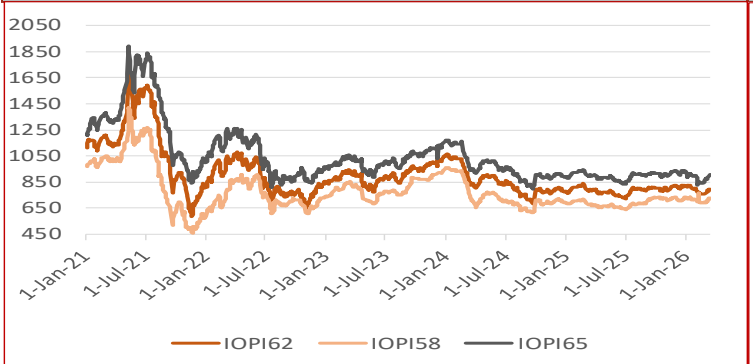
IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE SPOT PRICE ASSESSMENTS AND COMPOSITE INDEX

Week Ending Mar 13th, 2026				RMB/tonne (excluding tax) [3]				USD/tonne (excluding tax) [3]			
Province	Region	Product	Basis	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Hebei	Hanxing	66% Fe Concentrate	Dry	927	1.9%	859	1226	134.34	2.00%	119.88	172.59
Hebei	Qian'an	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	975	0.5%	880	1300	141.29	0.65%	122.81	183.23
Liaoning	Anshan	65% Fe Concentrate	Wet	740	0.0%	690	970	107.24	0.13%	96.49	136.72
Shandong	Zibo	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	955	2.0%	878	1294	138.40	2.17%	122.53	182.16

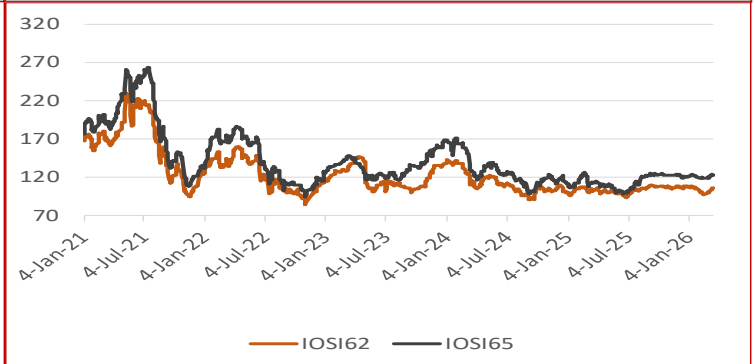
Week Ending Mar 13th, 2026	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
China Mines Concentrate Composite Index RMB/WT	858.04	-0.23%	802.20	905.40

[1] Exchange rate applied: RMB/USD = 7.191 [2] Last 12 months
[3] Weekly exchange rate applied: RMB/USD =7.19258

IRON ORE PORT INDEX, FOT QINGDAO (RMB/WT)



IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX, CFR QINGDAO (USD/DMT)



IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Mar 16th, 2026		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	November	December	January	February	MTD	QTD	YTD	November	December	January	February	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	805	798	810	769	787	782	828	105.46	100.24	107.43	102.60	102.55	101.93	108.09
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	720	716	719	699	694	689	727	95.02	94.72	96.04	93.94	90.90	90.22	95.56
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	917	925	900	852	896	892	938	120.64	122.17	119.85	114.11	117.28	116.70	122.96

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Mar 16th, 2026		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	November	December	January	February	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	106.33	105.42	106.27	99.65	103.47	102.80	109.07
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	122.46	121.09	121.51	118.61	115.59	114.78	123.67

FREIGHT RATES

Mar 13th, 2026		FREIGHT RATES - DRY BULK US$/wet tonne				
Route	Designation		Change	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
W. Australia - Qingdao	C5	12.96	0.98	8.2%	5.92	14.89
Tubarao - Qingdao	C3	29.66	1.26	4.4%	16.08	35.02

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Week Ending Mar 13th, 2026		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	November	December	January	February	MTD	QTD	YTD	November	December	January	February	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	880	864	875	844	895	891	953	114.52	110.83	111.50	108.31	112.19	111.76	119.69

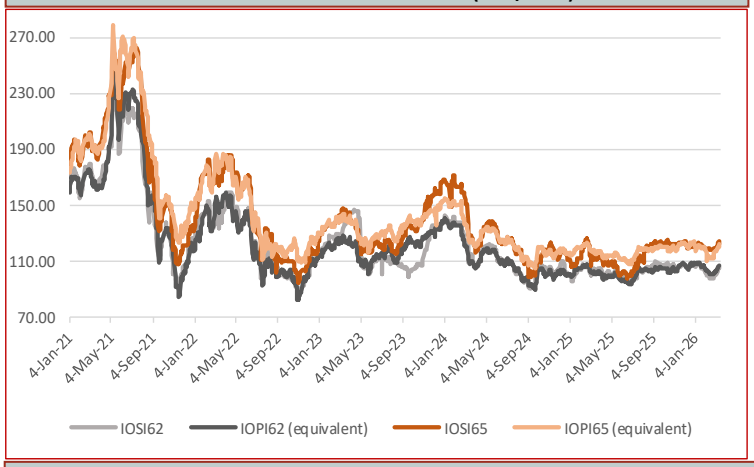
IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

Mar 16th, 2026		PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOPI62	% Spread to IOPI62
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	-72	-9.05%
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	108	13.61%

Mar 16th, 2026		SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOSI62	% Spread to IOSI62
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	17.35	16.47%

COPYRIGHT METALS MARKET INDEX, ALL RIGHTS RESERVED

IRON ORE INDEX COMPARISONS (USD/DMT)



CHINA DOMESTIC COMPOSITE MINES INDEX (RMB/Wet Tonne, including VAT)

IRON ORE BRAND SPOT PRICE ASSESMENTS

Mar 16th, 2026	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI62
Roy Hill	747	15	-49
SIMEC Fines	751	32	-45
PB Fines	806	-3	10
Newman Fines	802	-1	6
MAC Fines	794	5	-2
Jimblebar Blended Fines	704	-5	-92
Carajas Fines	905	-28	109
Brazilian SSF	826	39	30
Brazilian Blend Fines	848	12	52
RTX Fines	655	-23	-141
West Pilbara Fines	791	10	-5

Mar 16th, 2026	SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOSI62
Roy Hill	98.30	-0.20	-7.05
SIMEC Fines	94.75	-0.15	-10.60
PB Fines	105.05	-0.15	-0.30
Newman Fines	102.50	-0.15	-2.85
MAC Fines	101.60	-0.20	-3.75
Jimblebar Blended Fines	94.50	-0.15	-10.85
Carajas Fines	124.35	-0.15	19.00
Brazilian SSF	101.35	-0.15	-4.00
Brazilian Blend Fines	112.20	-0.15	6.85
RTX Fines	95.15	-0.15	-10.20
West Pilbara Fines	97.60	-0.15	-7.75

Mar 16th, 2026	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI58
SSF	672	0	-51
FMG Blended Fines	734	0	11
Robe River	729	0	6
Western Fines	678	0	-45
Atlas Fines	733	0	10
Yandi	705	0	-18

IRON ORE INDEX NORMALISATION DIFFERENTIALS

Port Stock Index Product Differentials (RMB/wet tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	5.00	-1.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	12.00	-3.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	12.00	-3.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	12.00	-3.00
	Low Grade Fe	16.00	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	55.00	5.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	66.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al <2.25%	20.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	16.00	0.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	13.00	-4.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4-6.5%	37.00	-7.00
	Low Fe Grade	25.00	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	30.00	5.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	30.00	5.00
	Low Fe Grade 0.09<P<0.1%	5.00	0.00

Seaborne Index Product Differentials (USD/dry tonne)

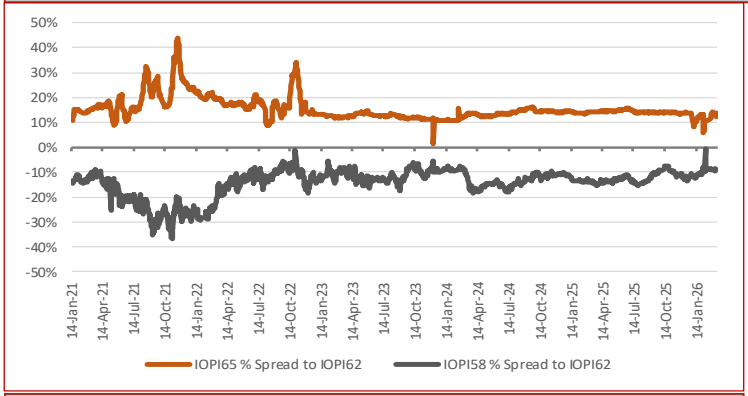
	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	4.75	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	2.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	2.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	2.00	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	7.75	0.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	7.75	0.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	2.25	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4 - 6.5%	6.50	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	1.75	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	1.75	0.00

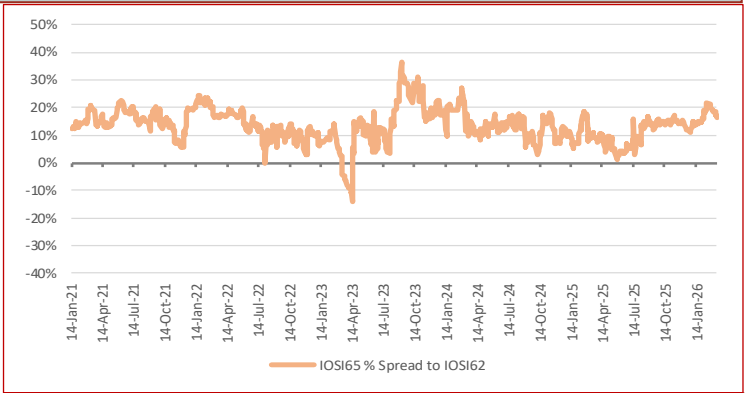
Port Stock Price Differentials to Qingdao Port for PB Fines (RMB/wet tonne)

Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change
Bayuquan	-20.00	0.00	Fangcheng	-25.00	0.00	Lanshan	0.00	0.00	Rizhao	0.00	0.00
Beilun	0.00	0.00	Jiangyin	-18.00	0.00	Lianyungang	-3.00	0.00	Shekou	0.00	0.00
Caofeidian	-15.00	5.00	Jingtang	-17.00	6.00	Majishan	0.00	0.00	Taicang	-18.00	2.00
Dalian	0.00	0.00	Lanqiao	0.00	0.00	Qingdao	0.00	0.00	Tianjin	-20.00	3.00

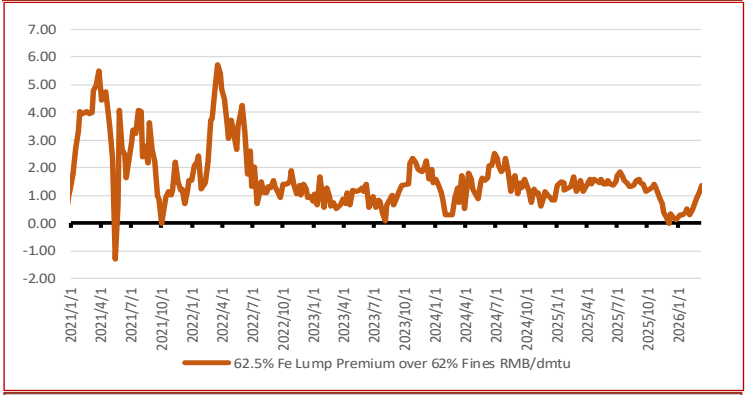
COPYRIGHT METALS MARKET INDEX, ALL RIGHTS RESERVED

IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

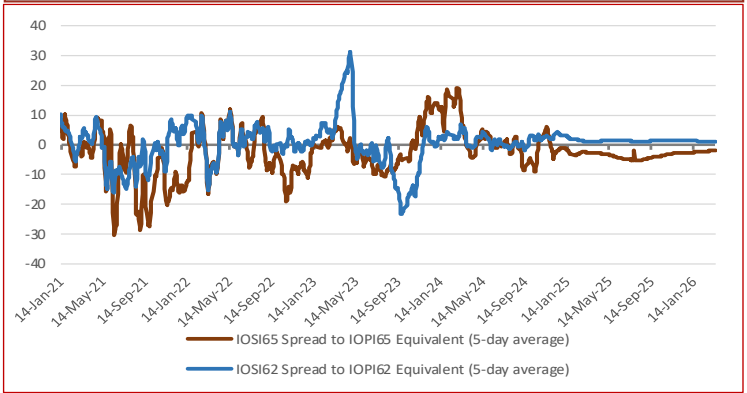




WEEKLY IRON ORE PORT STOCK LUMP PREMIUM (RMB/DMTU)

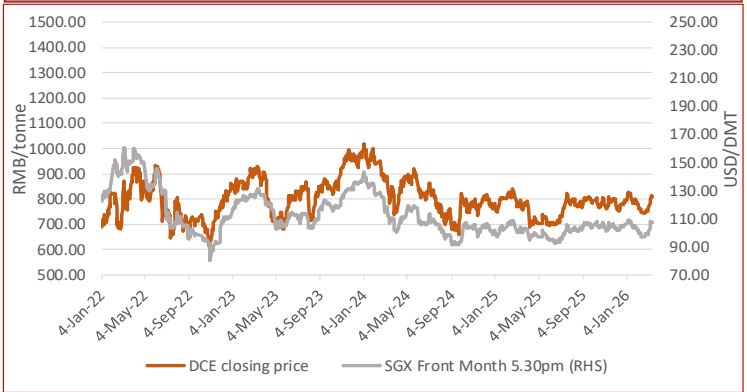


IRON ORE SEABORNE TO PORT STOCK PRICE SPREADS (USD/DMT)



TOTAL IRON ORE INVENTORIES AT CHINA PORTS (MILLION TONNES)

FUTURE TRADING—FRONT MONTH CLOSING PRICE



IRON ORE PORT INVENTORIES (MILLION TONNES)

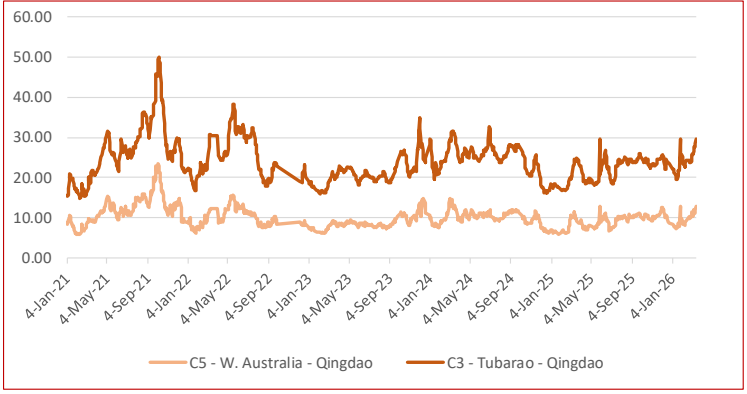
Week Ending Mar 13th, 2026

Province	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Jingtang	18.00	3.45%	8.29	18.00
Qingdao	32.19	0.72%	22.28	34.83
Caofeidian	17.52	2.22%	7.56	20.28
Tianjin	12.52	2.96%	6.64	12.52
Rizhao	12.42	-4.61%	11.52	21.35
Total (35 Ports)	155.41	0.39%	105.01	166.39

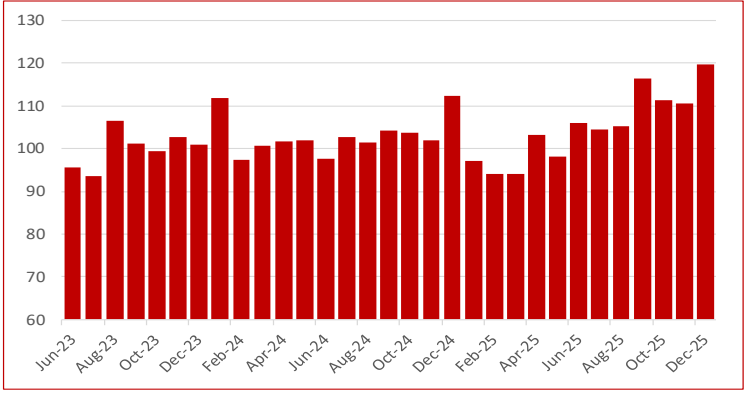
IRON ORE FUTURES CONTRACTS

	DCE (RMB/WMT)			SGX (USD/DMT)		
Closing Date	Mar 16th, 3pm close			Mar 16th, 5:30pm		
Contract	I2605	Change	Change %	Mar. 26	Change	Change %
Closing Price	809.00	-2.50	-0.31%	107.50	-0.15	-0.14%
Vol traded ('000 lots)	32.00	-13.06	-28.98%	12.57	-5.82	-31.67%
Open positions ('000 lots)	45.89	-1.26	-2.68%	47.66	0.17	0.37%
Day Low	794.0	-11.50	-1.43%	103.35	-3.35	-3.14%
Day High	810.0	-17.00	-2.06%	107.90	-0.95	-0.87%

DRY BULK FREIGHT RATES (USD/MT)



TOTAL CHINA IRON ORE IMPORT VOLUMES (MILLION TONNES)



COPYRIGHT METALS MARKET INDEX, ALL RIGHTS RESERVED

STEEL SPOT MARKET PRICES—CHINA

Steel Spot Market RMB/tonne

Product	2026/03/13	Change	Change %
ReBar HRB400 ϕ18mm	3,164	31	0.99%
Wirerod Q300 ϕ6.5mm	3,361	28	0.84%
HRC Q235/SS400 5.5mm*1500*C	3,282	57	1.76%
CRC SPCC/ST12 1.0mm*1250*2500	3,787	54	1.45%
Medium & Heavy Plate Q235B 20mm	3,377	50	1.50%
GI ST02Z 1.0mm*1000*C	4,037	23	0.58%
Colour Coated Plate	6,300	0	0.00%

CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY

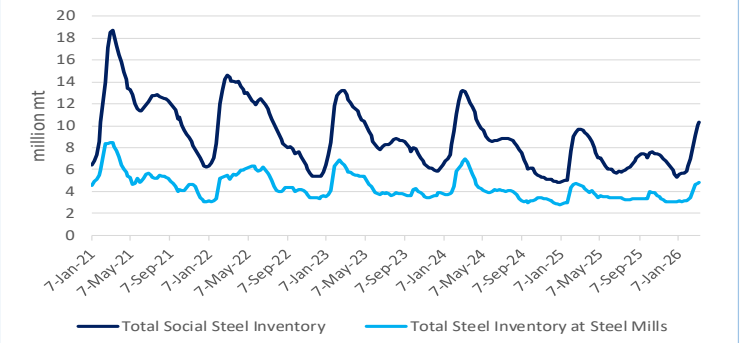
SMM Tracking of Steel Mill P&L - Rebar and Hot-rolled Coil (RMB/tonne)

Category	Price	Change (WoW)	Note
MMi (Fe 62%), USD/mt exluding tax	106.77	2.60	Mmi CFR Equivalent index for 1st Feb
Coke	1,605	0	2nd grade met coke, Tangshan, incl. tax
Steel Scrap	2,480	50	steel scrap (6mm) in Zhangjiagang, exl. tax
Billet Cost	2,563	36	Q234, incl. tax
Rebar cost - Blast furnace	3,123	41	calculated based on theoretical weight, incl. tax
Rebar profit - Blast furnace	7	-1	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil cost - Blast furnace	3,199	40	based on actual weight, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil proft - Blast furnace	91	10	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax

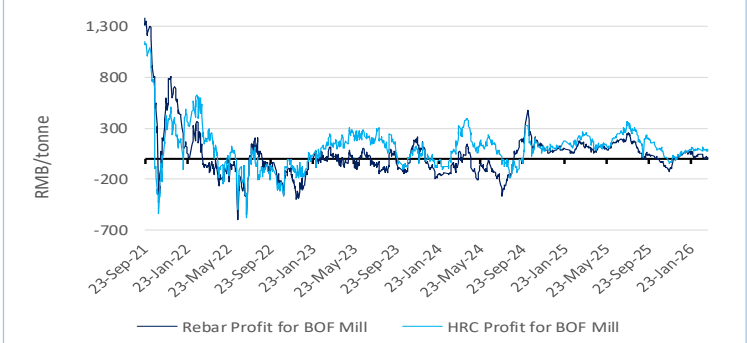
Note: 1. Costs in the table are caluclated based on todays market prices and facout our management, sales, financial and depreciations fe

2. The cost refers to average cost in the industry based on SMM's survey of small, medium and large mills in China

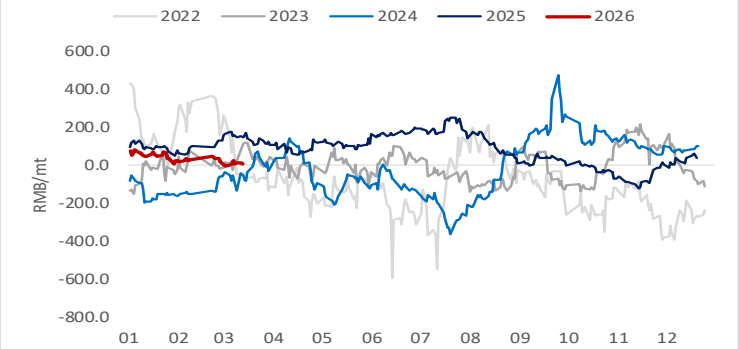
CHINESE STEEL INVENTORIES



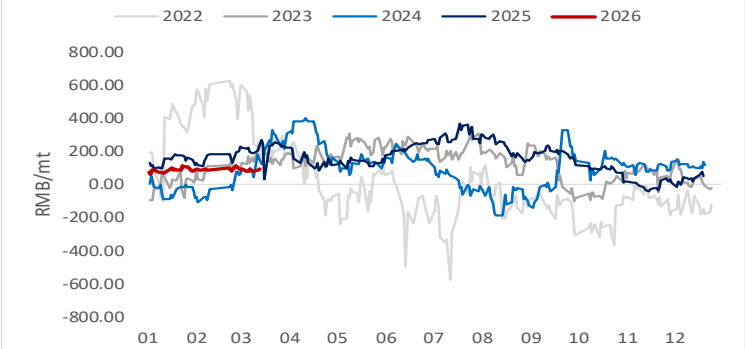
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY



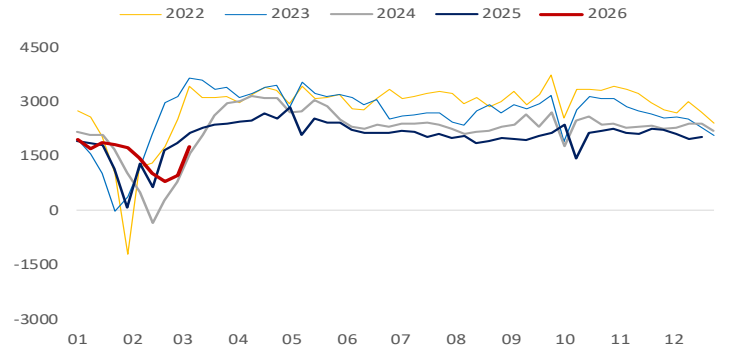
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Rebar



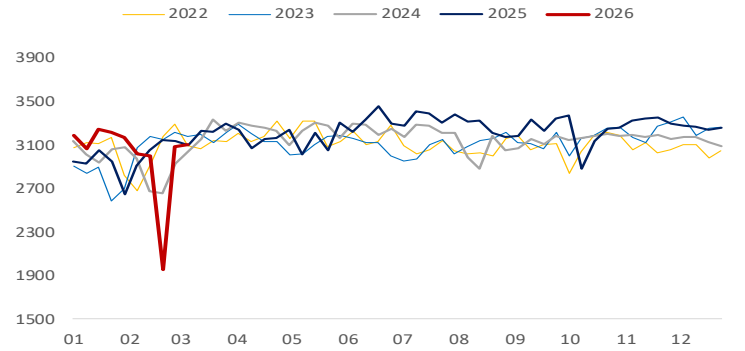
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Hot-rolled Coil



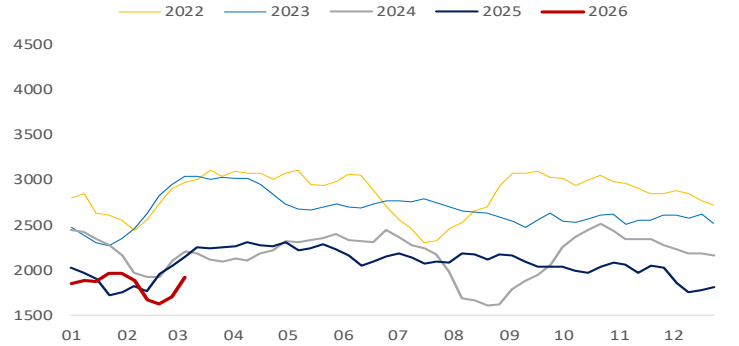
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Rebar



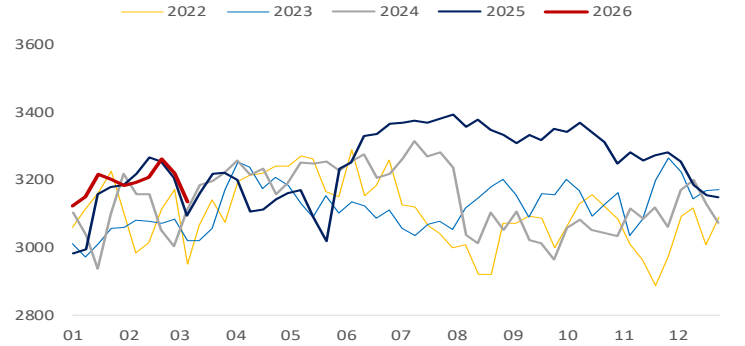
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Hot-rolled Coil



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Rebar



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Hot-rolled Coil



COPYRIGHT METALS MARKET INDEX, ALL RIGHTS RESERVED

IRON ORE INDEX SPECIFICATIONS, COMPILATION RATIONALE AND DATA EXCLUSIONS

Iron Ore Index Specifications (Port and Seaborne)

	65% Fe Fines	62% Fe Fines	58% Fe Fines	62.5% Fe Lump
Fe %	65.00	62.00	58.00	62.50
Alumina %	1.40	2.25	2.25	1.50
Silica%	1.50	4.00	5.50	3.50
Phosphorus %	0.06	0.09	0.05	0.08
Sulphur %	0.01	0.02	0.02	0.02
Moisture %	8.00	8.00	9.00	4.00
Sizing	Granular size below 10mm for at least 90% of cargo; maximum of 40% below 150 micron			Size below 6.3mm max 15% Size above 31.15mm max 25%
Pricing Point	Qingdao Port (FOT and CFR respectively)			FOT Qingdao Port
Timing (Seaborne)	Loading within 4 weeks, Delivery within 8 weeks			Delivery within 2 weeks
Payment Terms	L/C at sight			L/C at sight or CAD

Iron Ore Index Compilation Rationale and Data Exclusions

MMi iron ore indices are compiled from data provided by companies that are part of the iron ore supply chain and involved in spot market transactions. The indices are calculated using detailed transaction-level data submitted to MMi by these companies. This data is normalised to the appropriate specifications and screened to remove outliers before volume-weighted average prices are calculated from the remaining core set of data.

Data Exclusions*

	62%	58%	65%
Port Index	0	0	0
Seaborne index	0		0
Lump Index 62.5	0		

* Number of price submissions for iron ore indices that were excluded from index calculations today as they were anomalous and could not be verified

IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE INDEX CALCULATION METHODOLOGY

The compilation method for price index generally refers to the compilation method of CPI price index and other price indices, breakdown the price data and calculate the average value according to a certain method, taking the vertical axis as the regional composite index (average of different grade index) and the horizontal axis as the grade composite index (average of different regional index), a total composite index for domestic ore can be output ultimately. The process system is also adopted in the calculation i.e. each sub-index can be obtained as well.

AVERAGE IRON ORE SPECIFICATIONS APPLIED FOR BRAND PRICE ASSESSMENTS

PORT STOCK BRANDS

Mar 16th, 2026	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.88%	2.35%	4.45%	0.055%	9.26%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines	61.64%	2.31%	3.87%	0.099%	9.45%
Newman Fines	62.49%	2.31%	3.98%	0.090%	7.72%
MAC Fines	60.43%	2.38%	4.64%	0.078%	7.57%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.87%	2.95%	4.53%	0.111%	7.32%
Carajas Fines	64.90%	1.39%	1.82%	0.080%	7.78%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	62.56%	1.58%	4.79%	0.091%	8.72%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

Mar 16th, 2026	Specifications applied for 58% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
SSF	56.49%	3.20%	6.19%	0.065%	9.18%
FMG Blended Fines	58.20%	2.43%	5.54%	0.057%	8.29%
Robe River	56.44%	3.16%	5.73%	0.042%	8.44%
Western Fines	57.88%	2.87%	7.50%	0.062%	7.45%
Atlas Fines	58.00%	1.85%	5.50%	0.090%	9.00%
Yandi	56.87%	1.58%	6.41%	0.042%	9.53%

SEABORNE BRANDS

	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.70%	2.30%	4.90%	0.055%	8.00%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines 62%	62.00%	2.60%	4.30%	0.090%	9.50%
Newman Fines	62.30%	2.40%	4.40%	0.090%	8.00%
MAC Fines	60.80%	2.35%	4.70%	0.080%	7.80%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.50%	3.00%	4.50%	0.120%	8.00%
Carajas Fines	65.10%	1.50%	1.70%	0.080%	8.50%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	63.00%	1.50%	5.00%	0.070%	7.00%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

BLOOMBERG TICKERS

PORT STOCK INDICES

	FOT Qingdao (RMB/wet tonne)	CFR Qingdao Equivalent (USD/dry tonne)
IOPI62	IRCNQ001	IRCNQ004
IOPI58	IRCNQ002	IRCNQ005
IOPI65	IRCNQ003	IRCNQ006
IOPLI62	IRCN0036	IRCN0037

SEABORNE INDICES

	CFR Qingdao (USD/DMT)
IOSI62	IRCN0034
IOSI65	IRCN0035

CONTACT US

MMI Singapore Office Details: Level 28, Manulife Tower, 8 Cross Street Singapore. Tel: + 65 6850 7629 E: prices@mmiprices.com
SMM Singapore Office Details: Level 28, Manulife Tower, 8 Cross Street Singapore. Tel: + 65 6850 7630 E: service.en@smm.cn
SMM Shanghai Office Details: 9th FL, Building 9, Lujiazui Software Park, No.20, Lane 91, Pudong, Shanghai Tel: +86 021 5155 0306 E: service.en@smm.cn

This information has been prepared by Metals Market Index ("MMi"). Use of the information presented here is at your sole risk, and any content, material and/or data presented or otherwise obtained through your use of the information in this document is at your own discretion and risk and you will be solely responsible for any damage to you personally or your company or organisation or business associates whatsoever which in anyway results from the use, reliance or application of such content material and/or information. Certain data has been obtained from various sources and any copyright existing in such data shall remain the property of the source. Except for the foregoing, MMi retains all copyright within this document. The copying or redistribution of any part of this document without the express written authority of MMi is forbidden.

COPYRIGHT METALS MARKET INDEX, ALL RIGHTS RESERVED